

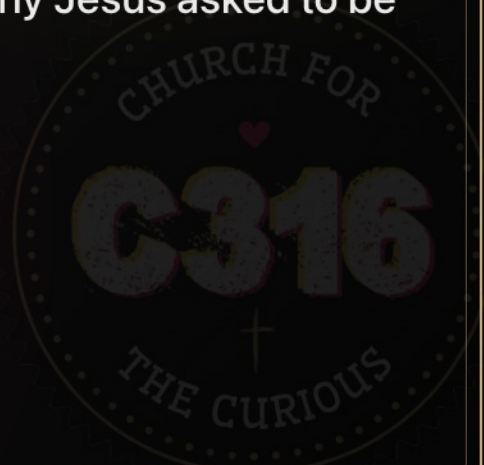
• PREACHING PACK · 1 OF 9

BAPTISM SUNDAY TEACHING

JOHN THE BAPTIST & THE BAPTISM OF JESUS

Why John baptised before Jesus — and why Jesus asked to be baptised.

SWIPE TO GO DEEPER →



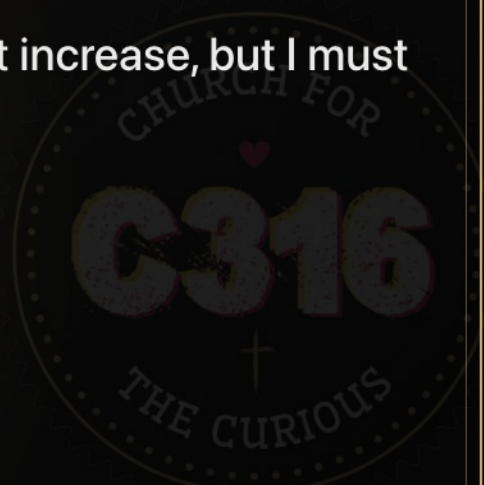
Who was John?

A prophet with a mission

John was sent to prepare the way for the Lord — calling Israel back to God (Isaiah 40:3).

Not the Messiah

He pointed away from himself: “He must increase, but I must decrease” (John 3:30).



MARK 1:2-4

“Behold, I am sending My messenger before You, who will prepare Your way... The voice of one calling out in the wilderness, ‘Prepare the way of the Lord...’”

John the Baptist appeared in the wilderness, preaching a baptism of repentance for the forgiveness of sins.



Why John baptised before Jesus

1. To prepare hearts

Baptism of repentance — turning from sin and getting ready for the King.

2. To fulfil prophecy

God promised a messenger before the Messiah (Malachi 3:1; Isaiah 40:3).

3. To point to Jesus

John's role was temporary. The greater baptism is in the Holy Spirit (Mark 1:8).



MATTHEW 3:13-15

Then Jesus arrived... at the Jordan, coming to John to be baptised by him. But John tried to prevent Him, saying, “I have the need to be baptised by You, and yet You are coming to me?”

But Jesus, answering, said to him, “Allow it at this time; for in this way it is fitting for us to fulfill all righteousness.”



Why Jesus asked to be baptised

Not because He sinned

Jesus is sinless. John's baptism was for repentance — Jesus had nothing to repent of.

To identify with us

He stepped into the water with sinners — beginning His mission to save them.

To fulfil all righteousness

Obedience to the Father's plan — the right thing, at the right time.



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MATTHEW 3:16–17

After He was baptised... the heavens were opened, and he saw the Spirit of God descending as a dove and settling on Him, and behold, a voice from the heavens said,

“This is My beloved Son, with whom I am well pleased.”



SWIPE →

Why this matters for us

Baptism points to Jesus

Like John, we don't make much of ourselves — we point to the Lamb of God.

Jesus went first

He entered the waters for us. Our baptism is a response: buried with Him, raised to new life.



THIS SUNDAY

John prepared the way. Jesus stepped into the water. Today we still respond — with faith, repentance, and a public yes.

“Behold, the Lamb of God who takes away the sin of the world!”

JOHN 1:29

Baptism Sunday · 19 July · 11:30am. Not too late to say yes.

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